Ethereum Community Hub Grant Proposal: Built Different R&D Lab

1. Executive Summary

Project Name: Ethereum Community Hub & R&D Lab
Location: Cnr Robert Mugabe and Orr street - Meikle's building, Harare, Zimbabwe
Organisation: Built Different (Active in Web3/Decentralization since 2020)
Grant Programme: Ethereum Foundation ESP - Community Hubs RFP

Introduction: The Cost of Being Left Out

Every year, thousands of young Zimbabweans graduate from universities with sharp minds and real ambition, only to enter an economy that has no space for them. Youth unemployment is not a statistic here; it is the defining challenge of a generation. These are not people lacking ability or drive. They are people lacking *access* to infrastructure, to networks, to the global economy that is quietly being rebuilt on open, borderless technology.

For the past five years, the Built Different team has been running Web3 and Ethereum events in Harare. We have watched, up close, what happens when you introduce a Zimbabwean developer or a young university graduate to the Ethereum ecosystem for the first time. Eyes light up. Questions fly. Then, almost without fail, the same conversation happens: *"This is incredible, but can I actually get paid to do this? Can I get a job?"*

For too long, our honest answer was: *maybe, if you build the skills and find your own way in.* That is not good enough. This proposal is our answer to that question and our commitment to making it a definitive yes.

What We Are Building

The **Built Different Ethereum Community Hub and R&D Lab** in Harare will be a permanently open, publicly accessible space for co-working, learning, and building on Ethereum and aligned technologies. It will sit at the intersection of three urgent needs:

1. African representation in the future being built. The Ethereum ecosystem is an open invitation, open source, permissionless, global. Yet the builders shaping it's future are overwhelmingly concentrated in a handful of cities in the Global North. Zimbabwe has brilliant, hungry builders. They deserve a seat at the table, not as recipients of the technology but as co-authors of it. This hub is how we put them there.

2. A direct, honest attack on youth unemployment. We are not building a lecture hall. We are building a pipeline from skill to income. Drawing on the proven tried and tested model our team ran at Muzinda Hub, where a six-person team trained over a thousand students and created employment and funded startups for a significant portion of them, we will run a rigorous Web3 and AI skills programme designed from day one with employment and entrepreneurship as the exit, not an afterthought. Every curriculum decision, every partnership we build, every project we take on through the hub's R&D function will be evaluated against one question: does this create real economic opportunity for the people in this room?

3. A home for the convergence of Ethereum and AI. We believe the most important technological development of this decade is not crypto alone or AI alone, it is the integration of the two. Autonomous agents that can own wallets, transact on-chain, and operate within trustless protocols are not science fiction; they are being built right now. The Ethereum ecosystem is the most natural home for this agentic future, and we want Zimbabwean and African developers to be among the people building it. Our curriculum will reflect this: Solidity, Account Abstraction, ZK Proofs, and stablecoins alongside AI inference, model training, and agentic system design.

Why We Are the Right Team

Built Different is not a new organisation standing in front of a big idea. We are a team with a specific and relevant track record. we have hosted numerous technical events, empowered over 300+ African developers, and actively contributed to public goods (including leading regional Translate-a-thons for the Ethereum.org ecosystem).

Our founder was an integral part of the Muzinda Hub (https://www.techzim.co.zw/2015/01/muzinda-hub-army-1000-zimbabwean-techies-entrepreneurs/) programme one of Zimbabwe's most successful technology education initiatives serving as a developer mentor/educator, project coordinator, and startup coordinator. Through that programme, our team helped train over a thousand students and directly supported the transition of graduates into employment and funded ventures. We know what a skills pipeline looks like when it works, and we know where it breaks down.

We have also been running active Web3 community events in Harare since 2020, building what grew into the largest, most active developer community in the country during that period. We have felt the energy in the room. We know our community. We also have a history developing what was the largest most active developer community in Harare and Zimbabwe at the time Facebook Developer Circle Harare. We have a centrally located, publicly accessible space, the former IBU Hub in Harare's city centre that has hosted our events before and is well-suited to become our permanent hub. It is accessible by public transport, safe, and centrally located.

We are not proposing to learn as we go. We are proposing to scale what we have already proven works, with Ethereum and AI as the engine.

Our Objectives

1. **Represent Africa in the building of the Ethereum ecosystem** - by developing Zimbabwean builders with the skills and community to contribute to the open-source protocols that will shape the next decade of the internet.

2. **Create a direct, measurable pathway from education to income** - through a structured skills programme, an embedded R&D function that brings paid external projects to hub members, a community startup funding model inspired by the African *susu* tradition of collective savings, and a corporate training and seminar stream.

3. **Build a permanent, open, and self-sustaining community anchor** - a place where developers, entrepreneurs, and curious minds in Harare can learn from each other, connect to the global Ethereum network, and build things that matter.

2. Organization and Applicant Background

Built Different:
We are a non-profit Web3 ecosystem builder that has been deeply active in the decentralized space since 2020. Our footprint spans Harare, Zimbabwe, and Kigali, Rwanda. Over the last five years, we have hosted numerous technical events, empowered over 300+ African developers, and actively contributed to public goods (including leading regional Translate-a-thons for the Ethereum.org ecosystem).

Leadership & Team:

- **Kuzivakwashe Muvezwa (Founder / Community Lead):**
  - *Former Facebook Developer Circles Lead:* Helped create and managed the largest and most active developer community in Zimbabwe for 4+ years, leading deep-dive training on PyTorch, AI, and AR/VR using Facebook open-source tools.
  - *Former Muzinda Hub (Startup & Project Coordinator):* An integral part of a 6-person team that trained 1,000+ students, directly facilitating job placement and startup acceleration.
  - *Web3 Architect:* Extensive experience utilizing the EVM, Smart Contracts, AI orchestration, and integrating crypto-rails for autonomous agent monetization.
    - Ethglobal 🏆 BuildQuest Best Multiplayer Award — *Caste* | EthGlobal, March 2022
    - Ethglobal 🌱 Lens Protocol Promising Seedlings Award — *Screen* | EthGlobal
  - https://www.linkedin.com/in/kuzivakwashemuvezwa/

- **Core Team:**
  - George Chakama Software Development and AI - https://www.linkedin.com/in/georgechakama/
  - Tafadzwa Aliyah Ndoro Growth, Operations and Marketing - https://www.linkedin.com/in/tafadzwa-aaliaya-ndoro-1a4558252/
  - Tinashe Bandera, Blockchain and Accounting - https://www.linkedin.com/in/tinashebandera/
    bringing robust experience in community management, technical operations, and ecosystem growth.

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3. The Community Hub Flagship Programme: A Skills Pipeline Built to Create Jobs

Why This Model Exists

The Built Different skills programme was not designed in a classroom or on a whiteboard. It was reverse-engineered from experience.

Part of our founding team spent years as part of the core team of **Muzinda Hub**, (https://www.techzim.co.zw/2015/01/muzinda-hub-army-1000-zimbabwean-techies-entrepreneurs/), one of Zimbabwe's most successful technology education initiatives. As a part of a six-person team, we helped train over a thousand students and critically we did not stop at graduation. We helped build the pipeline that took those graduates into employment. We sourced clients, assembled project teams, matched skill levels to task complexity, and created funded startups out of cohorts of people who months earlier, had never written a line of professional code. That experience taught us something that most skills programmes get wrong: **the goal is not to train people, it is to help employ them.** Training is the means. Income is the outcome. Every decision in this programme is made with that end in mind. (For a full technical breakdown of the curriculum methodology and modules, please see **Section 12: Technical Appendix** at the end of this document.)

What we are building at the Built Different Community Hub is the same model, rebuilt for the technologies that matter most right now: Ethereum, decentralised systems, and AI.

Understanding Our Students

One of the most counterintuitive and powerful realities of running a skills programme in Zimbabwe is the quality of the talent pool you are drawing from.

Because youth unemployment (https://www.unicef.org/zimbabwe/reports/investing-zimbabwes-youth-generation-unlimited) is so severe and so widespread, a single cohort will include people whose qualifications range from a secondary school certificate all the way to a master's degree or postgraduate qualification. A MBA graduate who cannot find work sits next to a recent Law graduate who sits next to a self-taught developer who has been building in his spare time for years. They are all in the same room for the same reason: the local economy has not made space for them.

This is not a problem for us, this is an opportunity. It means we have a natural spread of capability within every cohort, which maps directly onto a natural spread of roles in a professional software/solutions delivery environment.

Our most dedicated students will be capable of carrying out genuinely high-level work from relatively early in the programme. Our job as programme managers is to identify that quickly and channel it productively, while pulling the rest of the cohort up alongside them.

Phase 1 - The Academic & Certification Sprint (Months 1 - 3)

The first phase has one goal that goes beyond education: **verifiable credentialing**. Every student who completes Phase 1 exits with industry-recognised certifications that signal real competence to a global market. In an environment where a Zimbabwean developer cannot rely on institutional brand recognition to open doors, a Cyfrin Updraft certification is a credential that speaks for itself anywhere in the world.

The phase is structured around what we call a **"Low Floor, High Ceiling"** cohort model a deliberate design choice rooted in the reality of our student pool.

The **Low Floor** makes the programme radically accessible. By integrating DeepLearning.AI frameworks alongside Claude Code, we remove the initial friction of syntax and boilerplate from the learning experience. A marketing professional, a designer, or a junior developer who has never written a smart contract can begin prototyping on day one prompting contracts into existence, focusing on product thinking, market fit, and scaffolding rather than getting stuck on syntax. This is not a shortcut; it is a recalibration of where the real learning happens.

The **High Ceiling** ensures that accessibility never comes at the cost of rigour. While beginners are building and iterating, the more experienced developers in the same cohort and there will always be experienced developers in the cohort, given the nature of Zimbabwe's talent pool are working on the 10% of the stack that matters most: protocol security, economic modelling, gas optimisation, and the manual auditing of AI-generated code. The two tracks exist within a single unified cohort, which means collaboration and mentorship happen organically, daily, as a natural function of the room. This is a real-world Web3 product studio dynamic, and we are creating it from month one.

Month 1: AI Fundamentals & EVM Scaffolding

Core Materials: DeepLearning.AI ("AI for Everyone") · Cyfrin Updraft (Blockchain Basics)

The first month is about removing the fear of the stack and establishing a shared conceptual foundation across the entire cohort. Students learn to navigate the EVM as a mental model while AI tooling specifically Claude Code and Scaffold-ETH 2 handles boilerplate generation.

The milestone is concrete and confidence-building: by the end of month one, every participant regardless of prior experience will have deployed a functional Token and an NFT Gallery to a testnet. Not a tutorial exercise. An actual deployment. This early win is deliberate: it establishes from day one that building on Ethereum is within reach, and it creates the psychological foundation for everything that follows.

Month 2: Test-Driven Development & Foundry

Core Materials: Cyfrin Updraft (Foundry Fundamentals)

Month two is where the programme makes its most important pivot: from building to breaking. Students learn to write deterministic fuzz tests designed to find vulnerabilities in their own AI-generated protocols. The lesson is not subtle AI writes code quickly; AI also writes bugs quietly. The human engineer's value is not in producing code faster than a model; it is in knowing precisely where and how that code will fail.

The milestone for this month is the **Cyfrin Foundry Certification** an industry-recognised credential that validates students' ability to test smart contracts to a professional standard. This is the first of several certifications the cohort will accumulate across the programme, each one a portable, verifiable signal of competence.

Month 3: Security, Auditing & Capstone

Core Materials: Cyfrin Updraft (Smart Contract Security) · The Ethernaut

The final month of Phase 1 is the most demanding and the most important. Students move into smart contract security and auditing, the discipline that is most acutely undersupplied in

the global Ethereum talent market and, accordingly, one of the highest-value skills a developer can hold.

The centrepiece of this month is a **"Human vs. AI" audit exercise**. Students audit a set of contracts using automated tools, then audit the same contracts manually. The goal is not to prove that humans are better than machines, it is to develop the judgement to identify the deep logic flaws, economic attack vectors, and edge cases that automated tools consistently miss. This is where senior and junior students learn the most from each other, and where the mentorship dynamic within the cohort is at its most powerful.

Phase 1 concludes with a **capstone project**: the design and deployment of a locally-relevant dApp a decentralised publishing tool, a localised DeFi primitive, or a similar architecture grounded in a real Zimbabwean or African use case, that must pass a peer-reviewed security audit conducted by the cohort itself. Students leave Phase 1 with a live deployment, a portfolio piece, and a stack of certifications. They are no longer learners. They are engineers.

Phase 2 - The Studio & Deployment Sprint (Months 4 - 6)

At the start of month four, the room changes. The curriculum is gone. The cohort does not graduate and leave, they stay, and the space they have been working in becomes a functioning **Web3 development agency**. The whiteboard gets replaced by a client brief. The testnet gets replaced by the mainnet. The exercise gets replaced by a live product with a real user on the other end.

This transition is the whole point. Phase 1 exists to make Phase 2 possible.

Month 4: Client Onboarding & System Architecture

Teams are paired with real-world clients sourced through the hub's B2B pipeline or assigned to high-impact internal community projects where the brief is equally serious. The first month of Phase 2 is about translation: taking a client's problem, a product requirement, a business need, and turning it into a technical architecture that the team can build and defend.

Cohorts finalise product requirements, establish the initial AI-assisted codebase, and define the security constraints that will govern every subsequent decision. The habits built in Phase 1 testing first, auditing constantly, treating AI-generated code as a starting point rather than a final answer are now the operating culture of a team delivering work to a paying client.

Month 5: Iterative Hardening

Month five is governed by what we call the **90/10 deployment rule**: AI harnesses manage the 90% standardised interfaces, React integrations, boilerplate, repetitive scaffolding. Human engineers own the 10% that matters business logic, economic security constraints, the decisions that cannot be automated because they require genuine understanding of what the protocol is actually doing and what an attacker might try to do to it.

This is not a theoretical framework. It is a practical workflow discipline, and it is one that mirrors exactly how the best Web3 product studios in the world operate. By the time students leave this programme, they will not just understand this principle they will have lived it under the pressure of a real delivery timeline.

Month 6: Mainnet Launch & Handover

The programme ends with a deployment. Not a demo. Not a prototype. A live, security-audited product shipped to an EVM mainnet or Layer 2 handed over to a client or community stakeholder with the documentation, testing coverage, and audit trail to back it up.

Final security audits are conducted. The codebase is reviewed. The product goes live. Every student in the cohort has now done the thing that the vast majority of developers anywhere in the world have never done: shipped a production Web3 product from concept to mainnet.

How We Identify and Accelerate Top Talent

One of the clearest lessons from my Muzinda Hub years is that waiting until graduation to start creating economic outcomes is too slow for the students and for the programme's credibility.

From week three or four of the intensive phase, we are already identifying the students who are moving fastest. These individuals are brought into real client work early on small, well-scoped engagements where the risk is manageable and the learning is accelerating. This does two things simultaneously: it validates the programme's commercial model to the market from an early stage, and it creates visible, tangible proof within the cohort that the path from this room to a paying engagement is real and short. The effect on cohort motivation is significant.

Students who progress fastest are on track for three possible outcomes by the end of the six months: a contracted engagement through the hub's B2B pipeline, a position sourced through a growing network of local and international Web3 and AI companies, or a funded startup developed through the hub's community seed funding initiative. Realistically, not every student will achieve one of these outcomes within the programme window but our goal is for the majority to have a clear, active path toward one of them by the time they leave. Our road map and timelines are the ideal pathway we hope the majority of our students take but we are fuly aware that some students may need more time to achieve program milestones.

The Startup Track: Community-Funded, Rooted in African Tradition

Alongside the main programme, the hub will run a fortnightly startup funding initiative inspired by the African tradition of collective savings known in different communities across the continent and the Caribbean as *susu*, *chama*, *stokvel*, or *round*. The principle is the same everywhere: a community pools resources so that individuals within it can access capital they could not reach alone.

Our version works like this: once a month or once a fortnight as demand grows the hub hosts a **startup pitch night**. Participants pay a $20 entry fee to be considered. Ideas are submitted in advance; on the night of the community selects its ste$ 1,000 when fifty participants attend to invest directly in their idea.

In Zimbabwe's economic context, $1,000 is not a symbolic gesture. It is genuine seed capital: enough to register a company, build an MVP, pay for hosting and tooling for months, or bring on a first collaborator. More importantly, the night itself creates a culture of entrepreneurship,

peer accountability, and community investment inside the hub that no external programme can manufacture.

What the Ethereum Ecosystem Gets Back

Funding this programme yields returns that are measurable and specific.

Every graduate holds Cyfrin Updraft certifications a baseline guarantee of rigorous, modern security knowledge that is recognised across the global Ethereum developer community. They emerge as native users of Foundry, Scaffold-ETH 2, and AI-assisted development workflows, raising the technical floor of the local ecosystem. The final three months of the programme guarantee the deployment of functional, client-backed dApps driving real transaction volume and real-world utility on Ethereum networks, from Harare.

And the curriculum itself every module, every exercise, every framework will be released as **open-source and modular**. What we build here can be picked up and run by any other Ethereum Community Hub in the world. We are not just training engineers in Zimbabwe. We are prototyping a new standard for Web3 education that can propagate across the global hub network.

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4. Event Programming Structure

Monthly Events (12 Total)

One major community event each month, rotating through formats:

Month	Event Type	Purpose	Attendance
1	Build Day 1	Induction of new cohort (100-200 people) + orientation	60-100
2	Workshop 1	Technical deep-dive (Solidity, AI/ML, Agentic dApps)	60-100
3	Community Meetup	Networking, demos, peer learning	60-100
4	**Genesis Hackathon**	Q1 Hackathon - Web3 Fundamentals	60-100
5	Build Day 2	Induction + community meetup	60-100
6	**Demo Day**	First cohort graduation showcase	60-100
7	Workshop 2	Technical training (Advanced Solidity, ZK Proofs)	60-100
8	**AI x Web3 Hackathon**	Q2 Hackathon - Agentic dApps, LLM integration	60-100
9	Build Day 3	Induction + community meetup	60-100
10	Workshop 3	Technical training (L2s, Account Abstraction)	60-100
11	Community Meetup	Networking, advanced demos	60-100
12	**Grand Finale Demo Day**	Q3 Hackathon - Final cohort graduation, startup pitches	60-100

Quarterly Hackathons (3 Total)

One major hackathon every 4 months:

Quarter	Month	Event	Focus	Prize Pool
Q1	4	**Genesis Hackathon**	Web3 Fundamentals (Solidity, Smart Contracts)	$1,000
Q2	8	**AI x Web3 Hackathon**	Agentic dApps, RAG, LLM integration	$1,500
Q3	12	**Grand Finale Demo Day**	Graduate showcases, startup pitches, community awards	$2,000

Annual Event Summary

- **12 Monthly Community Events** (1 per month)
- **3 Quarterly Hackathons** (1 every 4 months)

Total: 15 events per year

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5. Venue & Facilities

Location:

Cnr Robert Mugabe and Orr Street, Meikle's Building, Harare CBD

Venue Status:

Secured via **zero-rent partnership** with established local co-working operator. Built Different provides programming, training support, managed placement and community; venue partner provides physical space, internet, and security.

Facilities Available:

Facility	Details
Event Space	60-100 seat capacity depending on configuration
Internet	Starlink Business - 100-150 Mbps download, 20-30 Mbps upload, low latency
AV Equipment	4K projector, 120" screen, wireless microphone, speaker system
Co-working Area	50 desks for hackathon participants and free hot desks for program participants
Meeting Rooms	2 x 8 - person rooms for team breakout sessions
Security	24/7 building security, secure access
Accessibility	Accessible, central location (5 min from most local public transport)

Equipment Built Different Brings:

- 5 laptops (loaner program for participants without hardware)
- Mobile streaming setup for live event broadcasts
- Curriculum materials and educational licenses

6. Target Demographic & Impact

Youth Unemployment Context:

Zimbabwe faces approximately **40% youth unemployment**, which includes everything from high school dropouts to university graduates. The local Ethereum community is small but growing. Built Different has proven demand with 20+ events and 300+ attendees to date.

Participant Profile:

- Developers seeking structured Web3 education
- Young people looking for an entry into Web3 and AI
- Students from local Colleges and Universities and other institutions
- Aspiring founders looking to build local solutions
- Existing developers transitioning to blockchain/AI

Impact Metrics (12-Month Targets):

Metric	**Target**
Total participants inducted	1,000
Wallets created	1,000
Smart contracts deployed	~500
Hackathon projects built	~100
Demo day presentations	50
Startups/serious projects emerging	10-15
Participants placed in B2B/income roles	50

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7. Sustainability & Revenue Model

The Proof Already Exists

Built Different's sustainability plan is not a projection built on optimism. It is a model built on a precedent, one we helped create, and one that is documented in the public record.

In 2014, **Muzinda Hub** was founded in Harare under the Higherlife Foundation, backed by Econet Wireless and billionaire philanthropist Strive Masiyiwa. It launched with a single, Africa-specific thesis that set it apart from every other tech incubator on the continent at the time: that the critical deliverable was not "big ideas", it was **job creation**. Disrupt Africa named Muzinda one of Africa's top five most disruptive incubators of 2014: incubators in Africa fall into the trap of emulating Silicon Valley models, whereas the focus should be on skills-based training and employment tailored for the reality of the continent.

That thesis was correct. By 2015, Muzinda had committed to training an army of 1,000 Zimbabwean techies and entrepreneurs, and Econet formally adopted the hub as one of its core subsidiaries, recognising the programme's impact and commercial potential after seeing our revenue figures. By 2019, the results were measurable at scale: Strive Masiyiwa announced publicly that Muzinda alumni had earned over millions in income from digital jobs since the programme's launch as freelancers building apps and websites for local and international clients. A further report found that the hub was creating real opportunities for young Zimbabweans who had no other pathway into the formal economy.

As part of the founding team at the operational core that built those results as a developer mentor, project coordinator, and startup coordinator, I worked directly on both sides of the pipeline, training students inside the programme and then sourcing clients, building teams, and managing delivery on the other side. We know how this model succeeds. We also know exactly where it is fragile, and we have designed the Built Different hub to address those points directly.

The key difference this time is the technology. Muzinda was built on mobile app and web development skills, valuable, but increasingly commoditised. We are building on **Ethereum, ZK cryptography, smart contract security, and AI-integrated agentic systems**: the skills that are most acutely undersupplied in the global market right now, and that command the highest premiums. The pipeline is the same but the earning potential for graduates is significantly higher.

Revenue Architecture: Four Streams, One Goal

The hub is designed with **four distinct revenue streams** that activate at different stages of maturity. No single stream carries the full weight of sustainability, and each one reinforces the others. Together, they are designed to make the hub and programs fully self-sustaining within 12 months of launch.

Stream 1: B2B Software Studio

This is the primary and highest-value revenue stream, and it is the direct commercial expression of the skills programme itself.

From month four of each cohort when students transition from Phase 1 certification training into Phase 2 live development the hub begins operating as a functioning **Web3 and AI development agency**. The business development function sources client briefs from local enterprises, regional organisations, and international Web3 projects seeking affordable, high-quality development capacity. The hub assembles teams from the cohort, manages delivery, and guarantees the output.

The revenue model is straightforward: the hub takes a percentage of each engagement fee, with the remainder distributed directly to the student developers who deliver the work. This means the stream simultaneously generates hub revenue and student income the two goals are not in tension, they are the same transaction.

This is precisely the model that generated employment for Muzinda Hub graduates at scale. The difference here is that Web3 and AI development commands global rate premiums that mobile and web development does not. A smart contract security audit, an Account Abstraction implementation, or an AI agent integration are not commoditised services. They are specialised, in-demand, and scarce which means the engagements we bring through the hub carry significantly higher margins than equivalent web development projects would.

As the hub's reputation builds and the cohort's portfolio of live mainnet deployments grows, the pipeline of inbound B2B opportunities will strengthen. By month seven, this stream is expected to be the hub's primary self-generated revenue source.

Stream 2: Corporate Training & Seminars

Our most advanced students, many of whom will hold postgraduate qualifications and prior professional experience, given the depth of Zimbabwe's educated unemployed talent pool will be deployed to run bespoke technology seminars inside corporate and enterprise clients.

Each seminar is purpose-built for the client: scoped to their industry, their existing technology stack, and the specific value they can extract from Web3 and AI tools. This is not a generic "intro to blockchain" presentation. It is a targeted, high-quality knowledge transfer engagement delivered by people who have just spent months building real products on these technologies.

Students who lead these engagements are paid. The hub takes a coordination fee. The client gets genuine, actionable knowledge from practitioners rather than consultants.

This stream serves a second function beyond revenue: it builds the hub's reputation and network within the Harare corporate market, which directly feeds the B2B studio pipeline. Every corporate training client is a potential B2B studio client or an employer for our graduates.

Stream 3: Community Co-Working Membership

The physical hub space will operate as a community co-working environment, accessible to the broader Harare tech and Web3 community beyond the active cohort.

We will run a **tiered access model**: a free tier that gives community members access the skills training program, to events, open workshops, and shared programming and hot seating/desking; and a paid membership tier that provides guaranteed desk access, reliable high-speed internet (Starlink Business), and priority booking for hub resources.

The free tier is not a compromise, it is a deliberate investment in community breadth and the long-term talent pipeline. Keeping the hub genuinely open and accessible to people who cannot yet afford membership ensures we are drawing from the full depth of Harare's talent pool, not just those who can pay. The paid tier is priced competitively with existing co-working spaces in the city, providing a clear value proposition: better infrastructure, a stronger technical community, and access to an active Web3 and AI ecosystem that does not exist anywhere else in Zimbabwe.

Stream 4: The Susu Startup Funding Pool

Once a month scaling to fortnightly as community size grows the hub hosts a **community startup pitch night**, inspired by the African collective savings tradition known across the continent and Caribbean as *susu*, *stokvel*, *chama*, or *round*.

The mechanics are simple: founders and builders pay a $20 entry fee toa pitch event where they submit their idea to the pool. The community/attendees select the ten strongest ideas from the submissions. Those ten pitch on the night. The room votes. The winner receives the full pool a minimum of $1,000 with fifty participants as direct seed funding for their venture.

This stream does three things simultaneously. It generates a recurring community event with a built-in revenue model. It creates a pipeline of early-stage ventures that may become future B2B studio clients/employers or hub-affiliated startups in which Built Different holds a small equity stake. And it creates a culture of entrepreneurship, peer accountability, and community investment that no external programme can manufacture because it is built by and for the community itself. We have more startup programs in the works.

12-Month Sustainability Timeline

Phase	Months	Primary Revenue Sources
Launch	1–3	EF grant funds all operations; first cohort begins Phase 1 training
Growth	4–6	EF grant + corporate sponsors activated; Phase 2 studio begins first client engagements; Susu pitch nights launch
Revenue	7–9	EF grant + B2B studio revenue from completed client projects + corporate training fees; co-working memberships open
Self-Sustaining	10–12	All four streams operational; hub covers core operating costs independently; EF grant functions as growth and programme capital rather than operational lifeline

The sequencing here mirrors the Muzinda Hub operational model, the grant provides the runway to build credibility and talent density; the talent density attracts clients; the client revenue sustains the infrastructure; the infrastructure attracts the next cohort. The flywheel, once turning, is self-reinforcing.

Built Different is not asking the Ethereum Foundation to fund an experiment. We are asking for the runway to rebuild a model that has already generated a significant amount in economic output for Zimbabwean youth this time, on Ethereum.

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8. Budget Specifications (12-Month Projection)

Total Request: $25,500 USD

Category	Item Description	Estimated Cost (USD)
Monthly Community Events (12 events)	Venue coordination, catering for 60-100, AV, streaming, materials	$18,000
Quarterly Hackathons (3 events)	**Genesis, Agentic Web3, Grand Finale :** prizes, professional judges, production, catering	$4,000
Educational Materials	Swag, certificates, curriculum licenses, participant handbooks	$1,500
Participant Support	Micro-stipends for LLM access for hackathon participants, loaner laptop hire	$1,000
Marketing	Ads and Marketing outreach for the program and events	$1,000
TOTAL REQUEST (12 Months)		**$25,500**

Budget Breakdown by Event Type:

Event Type	Quantity	Cost per Event	Subtotal
Monthly Community Events	12	$1,500	$18,000
Quarterly Hackathons	3	$1,333	$4,000
Educational & Support	—	—	$3,500
TOTAL	**15**	—	**$25,500**

9. Milestones & Deliverables

Month	Milestone	Deliverables
Month 1	Program Launch	Build Day 1- first 100-200 inducted
Month 2	Technical Training	Workshop - Solidity fundamentals
Month 3	Community Building	Community Meetup - networking, demos
Month 4	**Q1 Hackathon**	**Genesis Hackathon** - Web3 fundamentals focus
Month 5	Cohort 2-5 Active	Build Day 2 - ongoing induction
Month 6	**First Cohort Graduation**	Demo Day - 100-200 graduates showcase
Month 7	Advanced Training	Workshop - L2s, Account Abstraction
Month 8	**Q2 Hackathon**	**AI x Web3 Hackathon** - agentic dApps focus
Month 9	Cohort 6-8 Active	Build Day 3 - ongoing induction
Month 10	Technical Training	Workshop - ZK Proofs, advanced topics
Month 11	Community Building	Community Meetup - advanced demos
Month 12	**Final Graduation + Q3 Hackathon**	**Grand Finale Demo Day** - all cohorts, startup pitches

Cumulative by Month 12:

- 1,000 developers inducted and trained
- 15 events executed
- 45+ hackathon projects built
- 200+ demo day presentations
- 10-15 startups/projects emerging
- 100+ participants in full employment or income-generating roles (at least)

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10. Non-Financial Support Requested

Type	Description
Visibility	Official Ethereum Community Hub designation, social amplification
Educational Resources	Access to BuidlGuidl curriculum, EF educational materials, mentor matching
Network Access	Introductions to other African/global hub leaders, Technical co-hosting and Speaker placemen
Event Collaboration	Co-hosted/Streamed events with other hubs, EF speakers for major hackathons
Best Practices	For using AI in Ethereum development, Playbooks for training, community building, hackathon judging

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11. Why This Model Works

1. **Lightweight:** Low operational cost - 100% of funding goes to direct community impact through events

2. **Scalable:** Rolling cohort model allows continuous intake with less infrastructure bottlenecks

3. **Proven:** Built Different has hosted 20+ events with 300+ attendees, we also have a tried and tested model with our experience with Muzinda Hub and Community building and management experience with Facebook Developer Circle

4. **Sustainable:** Revenue model transitions to self-funding by Month 10 through corporate sponsors and Business Studio

5. **Alignment:** Is directly targeted at youth unemployment hot button issue in our Ecosystem

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Prepared by Built Different for the Ethereum Everywhere (EE) Community Hub Program
April 2026

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12. Technical Appendix: Web3 x AI Applied Engineering Accelerator Prospectus

I. Executive Summary: The Engineering Scarcity Bottleneck

The current growth constraint for Ethereum and its L2 ecosystem is no longer purely infrastructural; it is the scarcity of product-focused engineers capable of safe, rapid deployment. Simultaneously, the rise of agentic AI is fundamentally reshaping the software development lifecycle. This 6-month accelerator is designed to bridge this gap by merging foundational AI operational skills with industry-standard EVM engineering.

II. The Methodology: "Low Floor, High Ceiling"

Our pedagogical approach ensures that the ecosystem is served by both visionary product founders and rigorous protocol architects within a single, unified cohort.

The Low Floor (Accessibility & Prototyping)
Through the integration of DeepLearning.AI frameworks and Claude Code, we remove the initial friction of syntax. Marketing professionals, designers, and junior developers learn to "prompt" smart contracts into existence, focusing on market fit, product design, and rapid scaffolding.

The High Ceiling (Architecture & Security)
While beginners build the frontend and logic scaffolding, veteran developers within the same cohort focus on the 10% that matters most: protocol security, economic modeling, gas optimization, and manual auditing of AI-generated code.

This dual-track collaboration mimics a real-world Web3 product studio, fostering immediate mentorship and rapid iteration.

III. Curriculum Architecture: The 6-Month Roadmap

We utilize **Speedrun Ethereum** for rapid prototyping and rely exclusively on **Cyfrin Updraft** to establish the "ground truth" of security and industry standards.

Phase 1: The Academic & Certification Sprint (Months 1–3)

The goal of Phase 1 is verifiable credentialing. All cohort members will exit this phase holding industry-recognized certificates.

- **Month 1: AI Fundamentals & EVM Scaffolding**
  - *Core Materials:* DeepLearning.AI ("AI for Everyone") & Cyfrin Updraft (Blockchain Basics).
  - *Milestone:* Using Claude Code and Scaffold-ETH 2, every participant deploys a functional Token and NFT Gallery to a testnet. Students learn to navigate the EVM conceptually while AI handles boilerplate generation.
- **Month 2: Test-Driven Development & Foundry**
  - *Core Materials:* Cyfrin Updraft (Foundry Fundamentals).
  - *Milestone:* The cohort shifts from building to testing. Students learn to write deterministic Fuzz tests to break their own AI-generated protocols. Completion of the Foundry Certification.
- **Month 3: Security, Auditing, & Capstone**
  - *Core Materials:* Cyfrin Updraft (Smart Contract Security) & The Ethernaut.
  - *Milestone:* Students perform "Human vs. AI" audits, learning to identify deep logic flaws that automated tools miss. Phase 1 concludes with the deployment of a capstone architecture (e.g., a localized DeFi primitive or decentralized publishing tool) that passes a peer-reviewed security audit.

Phase 2: The Studio & Deployment Sprint (Months 4–6)

The cohort transitions from a classroom into a functioning Web3 development agency, generating immediate economic value and real-world utility.

- **Month 4: Client Onboarding & System Architecture**
  - Teams are paired with real-world clients or assigned high-impact internal community projects. Cohorts finalize product requirements and establish the initial AI-assisted codebase.
- **Month 5: Iterative Hardening**
  - Strict adherence to the 90/10 deployment rule. AI harnesses manage standardized interfaces and React integrations, while human engineers lock down business logic and economic security constraints.
- **Month 6: Mainnet Launch & Handover**
  - Final security audits and deployment to EVM mainnets or Layer 2s. The program concludes with the delivery of a live, revenue-ready Web3 product.

IV. Expected ROI for the Ethereum Community

1. **Verifiable Talent Pipeline:** By mandating Cyfrin Updraft certifications, we guarantee that graduates possess a baseline of rigorous, modern security knowledge.

2. **Ecosystem Tooling Adoption:** Graduates emerge as native users of Foundry, Scaffold-ETH 2, and AI harnessing tools, raising the technical standard of the local developer community.

3. **Live Mainnet Activity:** The final three months guarantee the deployment of functional, client-backed dApps, driving transaction volume and real-world utility.

4. **Scalable Community Framework:** This curriculum is fully open-source and modular. The methodology can be duplicated by other Ethereum Community Hubs globally, establishing a new global standard for Web3 education.

13. Appendix: External Links & References

Core Project Documentation & Heritage

- **Muzinda Hub 1,000 Techies Army Campaign:** TechZim - Muzinda Hub Army
- **Econet Formal Adoption of Muzinda Hub:** TechZim - Econet Adopts Muzinda
- **Income Generation Impact (reported earnings):** TechZim - Strive Masiyiwa on Student Earnings
- **Creating Opportunities for Zimbabwean Youth:** 263Chat - Muzinda Hub Impact
- **Top 5 Disruptive African Incubators Recognition:** Disrupt Africa - 2014 Review

Contextual Research & Social Impact

- **UNICEF Report: Investing in Zimbabwe's Youth:** UNICEF Zimbabwe - Generation Unlimited

Team Professional Profiles

- **Kuzivakwashe Muvezwa (Founder):** LinkedIn Profile
- **George Chakama (Technical/AI):** LinkedIn Profile
- **Tafadzwa Aliyah Ndoro (Growth/Ops):** LinkedIn Profile
- **Tinashe Bandera (Web3/Finance):** LinkedIn Profile